

“The Last Mask” Game Ideation

Premise

- PVE Metroidvania/action/adventure/platformer game with 2D sidescroller view. Explore, platform, and fight to uncover the truth behind you, your people, and the post-apocalyptic world you awoke in.
- Goal: A story driven game with an emotionally impactful narrative, obtained via exploration and overcoming of the game's challenges. Each challenge rewards players with pieces of the story, with each piece leaving a strong desire for the next.
- Selling point: Experience an impactful story about revenge and grief, all while mastering fluid platforming and combat that makes you feel unique and powerful.

Narrative

- Set in a post-apocalyptic, monster-filled world. All that seems to be left of civilization are ruins, bones, and left-over fragments of what it once was.
- You will play as the sole survivor of a demonic looking race who wore masks to hide their appearance and had high latent ability.
- You have been resurrected with no memory of who you are and with powers you know how to use, but can't explain. Journey through the lands, obtain fragments of your memory, grow stronger in battle, acquire lost abilities, and uncover the truth behind your resurrection, people, the apocalypse, and the higher powers behind it all

MDA

Core System & Mechanics: Exploration

- Although the game will have a good balance of combat, platforming, puzzle-solving, and all such elements which make a Metroidvania, the thing that starts it all is exploration.

- Players must take initiative in investigating areas of interest in order to uncover the story's narrative; puzzles, enemies, and platforming areas are consequently obstacles along the way.

Supporting System & Mechanics

- Status bars: While performing any combat or platforming actions players will have to manage 2 status bars
 - Hearts: the amount of life the player has, running out of hearts leads to death
 - Blood Flasks: the amount of blood players have to perform blood abilities
- Movement & Platforming: The ability to move, traverse, and scale areas (allowing players to go to any point of interest to explore)
 - Walk
 - Run
 - Jump
 - Wall slide & jump (obtained later in game)
- Combat: The foundation of the player's fighting abilities (allowing them to defeat enemies they may encounter that stand in their way while exploring)
 - Basic attack: depending on directional input, players can perform: attack combo (no dir, deal damage and end with a finisher), up attack (up, launches enemies into air for juggling), side attack (side, spacing tool), down attack (down, sweeping crowd control, or dive down on enemies)
 - Defend: depending on directional input, players can perform: barrier (covers entire body, reduces damage), teleport (in indicated dir, unsusceptible to damage for a brief period of time)
- Blood abilities: The protagonist's special blood magic abilities that add to his combat and movement capability
 - Heal: uses blood flasks to heal hearts
 - Collect: use your magic to manipulate all the blood around you and channel it to yourself to refill your blood flasks

- Blood types: players can switch between blood types to best suit the situation and their playstyles
 - Normal (standard damage)
 - Fire (applies DOT)
 - Ice (applies slow)
 - Lightning (applies chain damage)
 - Web (applies stuck)
 - Stone (breaks enemies guards)
 - Dark (very high burst damage and negates magic)
 - Light (very high constant damage and is the only thing effective against non-physical-dark-type enemies)
- Special attack: uses blood flask to perform special melee attacks
 - Normal (conjure floating blood blades and perform a short dash, the blades will slice anything trailing behind you)
 - Fire (charge and thrust forward a long spear, the tip explodes after a brief delay)
 - Ice (do a wide and low sweep with a blade on chain, creating a vortex of snow, then jump up and slam the blade into the ground to make the snow explode into ice)
 - Lightning (slash a great distance forward with a katana, slicing through any enemies in your path)
 - Web (close the distance and web to an enemy in front of you, following up with a punch and combostarter upwards kick)
 - Stone (spin a giant hammer in a circle and finish with slam into the ground, sending a wave of spiky stones in front of you)
 - Light (teleport a short distance in front of you and perform blinding fast repeated thrusts with a rapier of light)
 - Dark (perform a spinning slash that cuts all of space along the horizontal axis after a brief delay)
- Blood Art: uses blood flask to perform ranged and/or utility techniques
 - Normal (med range throwing kunai made by blood)
 - Fire (mid range exploding fireball)

- Ice (short range frost breath)
- Lightning (long range rail gun)
- Web (long range grapple)
- Stone (short range, raise a pillar of earth from the ground to step on)
- Light (fire a mid range sustained volley of light)
- Dark (absorb all non-physical attacks into a short range black hole)

Dynamics

- Game flow is mostly linear. Players will need to complete main objectives and obtain certain abilities to progress the main narrative and access larger main areas. However, they are free to backtrack and explore any smaller sub areas they have access to at any point. Narrative will be provided each time a player completes an objective, with main narrative being the reward for main objectives, and extra (optional) narrative being the reward for side objectives.
- Gameplay loop consists of:
 1. Enter new area (overworld, dungeon, temple, etc.), explore and platform around
 2. Find secrets/fight enemies/solve puzzles/acquire items/etc.
 3. Repeat 1 & 2 until either finding: new area, miniboss, or boss
 4. In the case of finding a miniboss/boss, defeat them, then go back to step 3
- Possible playstyles: with the player having access to 8 types of blood abilities, all with different speeds, power, and properties, they do have some choice in playstyle. They could be:
 - quick, close ranged, hit and run specialists with the normal and light blood
 - a mid range, burst damage spacer with the fire blood
 - speedy fighters that can zip and slice through crowds with lightning blood
 - balanced combo specialists with web blood

- slower fighters with wide AOE crowd control abilities with ice, stone, and dark blood
- Note: would also like to add some sort of equip system that changes or adds properties to certain attacks and abilities to give players even more choice with how they want to play. Similar to "Hollow Knight" pins.
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Aesthetics: core experience is immersive, curious, and powerful

Market & Platform

- The game will mainly appeal to those who enjoy an immersive story (as well as a bit of action, power achievement and discovery)
- Target market are young adults and up, those who can master challenging mechanics and have the emotional maturity to understand the deeper story
- Target platforms are PC and console (everyone should have access to fun games regardless of preference)

Art & Sound

- Art will be iconic, vivid, and "dark-cute" for efficiency, visual spectacle, and to match the tone of the story
- Sounds effects will have lots of bass boosted booms, sharp whooshes, techno noises for magic, and so on; all to have an immersive audio experience that matches the visual spectacle
- Music will vary between areas, but most will have a somber tone to reflect the empty apocalyptic world, while others are more intense and fast paced to match the action parts of the game

Other Inspirations

- The 5 stages of grief, animation and visuals like "Demon Slayer" anime
- Inspirations from "Hollow Knight", "Tunic", and "Death's Door"